



Aalto University

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Modeling Subjective Psychosocial Signals in Social Media via Pairwise Comparison and Pseudo-Labeling - Privacy Notice

This privacy notice describes how your personal data will be used in the research study as a participating individual. You have also been provided with a document called “Participant Information Sheet”, which explains in more detail how the study is carried out.

1. What is being studied in this research study and the purpose of processing personal data

This research study examines whether pairwise comparison-based preferences and statistical analysis can scale the inference for social media constructs. It processes social media data and human annotations to identify online expressions of psychosocial phenomena, such as restlessness, worry, stress, loneliness, toxicity, and disagreement.

This research is funded Research Council of Finland

2. What personal data is processed in the research study

Data presented to the participants from other sources:

1. Social media posts, selected from public posts of a large collection of social media users.
2. Synthetic text in style of social media posts.

Data collected from the participants:

1. Participant pair-wise judgements of these posts.
2. Participant demographic details associated with their Prolific ID (see below).

Special categories of personal data (sensitive personal data)

Data belonging to special categories of personal data or other specially protected personal data **will not be processed** in the research study.

Personal data is collected from the following sources:

From the participant: Participants provide pair-wise comparative preferences for the presence of socio-psychological signals being studied. The demographic information provided by the participant to the Prolific platform: *age, gender, first language, current country of residence, nationality, country of birth, student status, employment status* will be collected if they have been provided by the participants to Prolific.

The research methods are described in detail in the “Participant Information Sheet” -document.

3. Processing of necessary personal data and removal of the direct identifiers from the data

The research study only processes personal data that is necessary for the purpose and execution of the study. The research data is processed during the analysis phase of the research in a manner that is not directly identifiable to the researchers. Your Prolific ID will be removed after the data gathering phase.

4. Legal basis for the processing of personal data

The legal basis is scientific research, a task in the public interest

5. Sharing personal data

Research data containing your personal data is shared with the following parties:

Research data containing your personal data is primarily processed within Aalto University and is not shared with external parties in identifiable form.

Independent controllers: Research data is not routinely shared with external independent controllers. However, as part of the scientific publishing process, research data containing personal data may be shared with third parties such as scientific publishers or peer reviewers for the purposes of reproducibility, validation and peer review. The shared data will not contain any identifiers.

Research data containing personal data (after removal of all identifiers) are retained for research data to be used for further scientific research in the same scientific discipline or in other disciplines that support this research study. Research data may also be transferred to other universities or research organisations as part of further research projects.

Processors: Certain technical service providers may process data on behalf of Aalto University under contractual agreements. These may include providers of secure data storage and computing infrastructure (e.g., Aalto-managed servers and high-performance computing systems). These parties act strictly as data processors and handle data only under the instructions of Aalto University.

All data shared with collaborators or accessed remotely is in pseudonymized form, where direct identifiers such as names and contact details have been removed or replaced with random identifiers.

6. International data transfers

Research data containing personal data will not be transferred outside the European Union/ European Economic Area or to international organizations.

7. Storage and protection of personal data

Protection of manual material: Not applicable (N/A). The study is entirely digital and remote.

Information processed in IT systems: Data is housed on centrally managed Aalto IT systems, specifically Teamwork network drives and the Triton HPC cluster, which are rated for “Confidential” level security. Access is technically restricted via department-managed Unix groups, requiring centralized Aalto multi-factor authentication limited strictly to the designated project team.

The research data is archived: Pseudonymized research data may be retained within secure Aalto-managed storage systems for future scientific research in the same or related fields, in accordance with the data retention policy described below. No personal data will be made publicly available.

8. Retention and deletion of personal data

Deletion during and after the study

Research data containing personal data will be securely retained to ensure compliance with scientific reproducibility standards. All research data containing personal data will be completely deleted five (5) years after the date of the last scientific publication generated from the dataset. Any temporary identifying administrative information (such as Prolific ID) will be purged immediately once the study data collection phase concludes.

9. Rights of the research participant

According to the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), a data subject has the right to:

- receive information on the processing of their personal data
- right to access the personal data collected and processed
- right to rectification of inaccurate personal data
- request that the processing of personal data be restricted
- object the processing of personal data
- right to erasure of personal data if the conditions of Article 17(1) of the Data Protection Regulation are met and processing is no longer necessary for archiving purposes in the public interest or for scientific research or statistical purposes in accordance with Article 89(1)

If the research purpose does not require, or no longer requires the identification of the data subject, the controller shall not be obliged to obtain further information so that the data or the data subject may be identified only for purposes to enable the data subject to exercise his/her rights. If the controller is unable to link the data to a particular data subject, the data subject does not have the right to access or correct the personal data, object the processing, or delete the personal data. However, if the data subject provides additional information that allows their identification from the research data, the rights will not be restricted.

10. Contact details of the controller

The controller of this research study is Aalto University Foundation sr., operating as Aalto University.

Person in charge of the research study

Questions regarding the conduct of the research study may be addressed to the person in charge of the study:

Name: Talayeh Aledavood
Telephone 0505632634
Email talayeh.aledavood@aalto.fi

Data Protection Officer

If the research participant has questions or requests related to data protection or the processing of personal data, the research participant should contact the Data Protection Officer of Aalto University: tel. +358 9 47001 (exchange), dpo@aalto.fi .

In this data request service, you can request the exercise of your rights under GDPR from Aalto University as the controller <https://datarequest.aalto.fi/en-US/>.

If a participant of the research study feels that his or her personal data has been processed in violation of data protection legislation, the participant has the right to lodge a complaint with the supervisory authority, the Data Protection Ombudsman's office (read more: <http://www.tietosuoja.fi>).